where visitors from infected parts of the world had landed) and very few people (about 500 in all) were actually infected, with less than ten deaths.

Lockdown 1 and 2 (the last week of March and the entire month of April) turned out to be extremely severe. Only agriculture and government expenditure, which constitute about 25 per cent of GVA, remained exempt and unaffected. The rest of the economy (mining, construction, manufacturing and services included), which makes up about 75 per cent of GVA, was massively impacted. About 70 per cent of this economy remained shuttered for the entire month of April. This meant about 50 per cent of monthly GDP output was lost in April. Lockdown 3 (the first half of May) opened up India a little and Lockdown 4 (the second half of May) allowed some more productive activities to commence. Yet the country lost about 25 per cent of monthly output in May as well.

Unlocking of India became more effective from the first week of June 2020. As time went by, most sectors were unlocked in phases. However, education, entertainment, metro and quite a few other services remained completely shuttered until August–September 2020. As a number of services are availed in close human contact, such as transportation, travel and personal salon services, they remained hugely subdued even after the economy was unlocked. It was no surprise that the Purchase Managers' Index (PMI) for services remained below thirty-five in July 2020, while PMI manufacturing crawled to about forty-six (though still in the contraction zone) in July. The PMI manufacturing and services indices returned to positive territory only in August and October 2020. The Index of Industrial Production (IIP) remained in negative growth territory for all months except one in the first nine months of financial year 2020–21 and the Index of Core Industries remained in the negative zone all through this period.